

Miscellaneous phrases

attend a meeting to go to a meeting or class: *Only seven people attended our last meeting.*

clash (of cultures/opinions etc.) an example of opposition or disagreement between two parties or cultures: *They're both very determined people so there's rather a clash of personalities.*

express yourself to let others know your thoughts and feelings: *Many people find it difficult to express themselves in a foreign language.*

fast food chain a group of fast-food restaurants which are of similar design and are owned by a single company: *It was the first American fast food chain to establish itself in China.* (Also **hotel chain**, **restaurant chain**, **coffee shop chain**.)

(have a) good command of sth to have a good knowledge of something, especially a language: *You need a good command of French for this job.*

mass tourism tourism involving very large numbers of people: *The coastline has seen the effects of mass tourism over the last twenty years.* Also **a mass protest.**

over and over again repeatedly: *He made us repeat the phrase over and over again.*

(take a) pro-active approach (to sth) an approach where you are able to control and change events rather than having to react to them: *We take a proactive approach to customer service.* (opposite = **a reactive approach**.)

read aloud to say the words in a book, newspaper etc. so that others can hear them: *The teacher told me to read the sentence aloud.*

(make / write a) rough draft of sth a piece of writing, or a plan that is not yet in its finished form: *Let's make a rough draft of the letter before we send it.* Also **a first / final draft.**

scrap (of cloth, paper etc.) a small, untidy piece of paper or cloth: *I wrote his address down on a scrap of paper which I promptly lost.*

set (high) standards to decide what level is expected: *The government is determined to set high standards in schools.*

standard of living the amount of wealth, comfort and things that a particular person, group or country has: *Our standard of living is much higher now than 50 fifty years ago.*

take part (+ in) to participate in an activity with other people: *She was invited to take part in a TV debate on globalisation.*

way of life how people live in terms of their customs, habits etc: *The way of life in the countryside is very different.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable phrase.

- 1 The discovery of oil in the 1950s led to a dramatic improvement in the _____ for people of this region.
- 2 There have been angry _____ of opinion in the Senate between supporters and opponents of the President.
- 3 Over the last few years, Mom's Fried Chicken has become one of the most popular _____ in the U.S.A., with branches in over thirty states.
- 4 What this company needs to do is take a _____ to its financial situation: we've spent too long letting things happen.
- 5 We need someone who has a _____ English, as well as excellent communication skills.
- 6 As a teenager, the only way Sandra was able to _____ was through her dancing.
- 7 Tracey's parents always _____ for her as a child, and expected her to do well in all aspects of her school life.
- 8 Many busy city people would probably prefer a quieter _____ in the country.
- 9 It's much better to buy a proper exercise book rather than writing your notes on a _____.
- 10 It may help your pronunciation to _____ some of the texts in the *Cutting Edge Workbook*.
- 11 Many actors learn their lines by repeating them _____.
- 12 It's generally a good idea to make a _____ of your composition before you start writing the final version.
- 13 I'm afraid Ms. Schiaffa is not in the office this morning: she's _____ in Chicago and won't be back till tomorrow.
- 14 The arrival of _____ in the 1970s saw a huge increase in the number of hotels in the country.
- 15 More than 50,000 people are believed to have _____ in the anti-globalisation march through the city centre today.

Useful Language

Match the halves of the sentences to make a correct sentence. (See the Useful Language box on p.12 of the Students' Book).

a I'm the kind of person who...	1 ... about my pronunciation.
b One thing I'm good at is...	2 ... aiming to read more widely in English.
c One of my worst faults is I never...	3 ... is very useful.
d I feel pretty happy...	4 ... my main priorities.
e I don't feel that learning idioms...	5 ... needs to see things written down.
f Personally I'd like to concentrate...	6 ... on spoken English.
g My main aim is...	7 ... is grammar.
h Reading longer texts is one of...	8 ... watch English-language films in class.
i Another important area for me...	9 ... to improve my writing.
j So, for that reason I'm...	10 ... at some of the most common phrasal verbs.
k Another thing I thought might be a good idea is to...	11 ... working out the meaning of words I haven't seen before.
l I'd find it really useful to look...	12 ... remember to write down new vocabulary.

Phrasal verbs

catch up (+ with) [T] to come from behind and reach the same level as someone who is ahead of you: *Can't you drive any faster? They're catching up with us.*

come up [I] to appear or happen in a way that requires attention: *A lot of important questions came up at the meeting.*

cut off (be) [I] to be completely separated from other places or people: *In winter, the village is often cut off by snow.*

give way to [T] to have its place taken by something else: *In the last century steam trains gave way to electric trains.*

go ahead [I] to take place as planned: *The sale went ahead without problems.*

go by (of time etc.) [I] to pass: *As the years went by, Mary and Elizabeth gradually lost touch with each other.*

go over [T] to look at or check something very carefully: *The police went over my statement very carefully.* Also **go through**: [T] *I searched my flat and went through all my pockets but I couldn't find the keys anywhere.*

hand in (+ to) [T] to give something to a person in authority, e.g. an official or teacher: *Hand your papers in at the end of the exam.*

head for [T] move towards: *There was a lot to discuss after the conference so we all headed for the coffee bar to exchange our views.*

lag behind [I,T] to move or develop more slowly than others: *Our social reforms are still lagging behind other countries.*

miss out [T] to not include something: *This document is extremely important. Make sure you don't miss any details out.*

pull down [T] to demolish a building that is no longer used: *The old chapel is dangerous and will have to be pulled down.*

put out [T] to extinguish something, e.g. a fire or cigarette: *This is a non-smoking area. Could you put out your cigarette, please?*

put up [T] to construct or build a wall, building or statue: *They're putting up several new office blocks in the centre of town.*

run out (+ of) [T] to come to an end, so that there is no more; to be completely used up: *Is there any sugar in the cupboard? No, I must go to the supermarket, we've completely run out.*

sort out [T] to organise something that is mixed up or untidy: *My room's in a terrible state. I must sort out all my books and records.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable phrasal verb.

- As soon as the sun came out, everyone _____ the beach.
- Promise me that you'll have _____ this mess by the time we get back.
- If you found a purse on the street, what would you do? Would you _____ it _____ to the police?
- They got very hungry on the desert island as the food they had brought with them soon _____.
- Platform shoes will eventually _____ to another crazy fashion.
- People seem to be confused about this point. Would it be possible to _____ the explanation once again?
- As the years _____, the town gradually lost its once peaceful atmosphere.
- It was several years after his death that someone first suggested _____ a statue of the former president in his home town.
- Having missed several lessons due to illness, Lee found it difficult to _____ with the other students in the class.
- Despite recent wage increases and greater equality between the sexes, women's salaries still _____ what men earn.
- It took firemen several hours to _____ the fire, which began as a result of an electrical fault.
- In order to build the new shopping mall, a lot of the old buildings had to be _____.
- Despite the rain, the outdoor concert is expected to _____ as planned.
- The floods meant that several towns were _____ from the outside world for several days.
- When we wrote the final version of the story, we decided to _____ some of the descriptions.
- One word that _____ in the text was 'standard'. What does it mean in this context?

Idioms

all the time in the world to have a lot of time so you don't need to hurry: *No need to rush – we've got all the time in the world.*

blockbuster (movie / novel etc.) a movie or novel that is very well-known and commercially successful: *The latest Hollywood blockbuster is making a lot of money.*

cost the earth to cost a very large amount of money: *What a beautiful necklace! It must've cost the earth!*

earth-shattering surprising and shocking and very important: *We heard the earth-shattering news about the assassination.*

get off the ground (of a plan or business) to start to become real or successful: *It took a while for the business to get off the ground, but now we're making a profit.*

good number (+ of) a fairly large quantity of something: *She had a good number of friends in the area.*

go global become known or available throughout the world: *Japanese food was hardly known abroad until the 1990s, but now it has truly gone global and you can get it anywhere.*

ground sbdy to punish somebody by not allowing them to go out: *My son was late home again, so I grounded him for a week.*

keep your feet on the ground to think in a sensible and practical way and not have ideas which are impossible to achieve: *I'm afraid not all Nigel's plans are realistic. He really needs to keep his feet on the ground.*

on top of the world extremely happy: *It was a lovely day and I was feeling on top of the world.*

out of this world informal so good or enjoyable, it is unlike anything you usually experience: *Tracy showed us her holiday photos last night, the hotel she stayed in was out of this world.*

pick up to learn something by chance rather than by studying it: *I picked up a few words of Greek while I was there on holiday.*

stick to sth to stay with sth, e.g. an idea or principle even if it is difficult: *I really want to lose some weight, so I'm determined to stick to this diet.*

think the world of sbdy to have great love and respect for someone: *I don't speak to my father now, but I always thought the world of him when I was little.*

wax (euphoric/lyrical/eloquent etc) about to become very enthusiastic about something: *She waxed euphoric about her new job.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable idiom.

- 1 Although there has been a lot of criticism of his handling of the economy, the Prime Minister is determined to _____ his original policy.
- 2 Becoming a millionaire at such a young age might've changed him, but his family have helped him to _____.
- 3 I've _____ a lot of English slang by watching TV, films and listening to pop songs.
- 4 He _____ as he described his plans for the new house.
- 5 After winning the gold medal, Lukic looked _____ as he spoke to reporters.
- 6 It needn't _____ to travel to Prague, you can get there by bus for only €180.
- 7 We thought about opening a restaurant, but unfortunately the idea never really _____.
- 8 Everyone in the office _____ of Rosalind, and we are all very sorry to see her leaving.
- 9 Antonia is a real genius in the kitchen: the meal she cooked for us last time was absolutely _____.
- 10 Everyone is still shocked and horrified at the _____ events that have taken place over the last few weeks.
- 11 There's no need to hurry: we've got _____ to get to the airport.
- 12 As a result of his irresponsible behaviour, Kevin's parents _____ him for a week so he couldn't go to the party.
- 13 From its origins in a small Los Angeles factory, the Lucky 7 clothing firm has now _____ and can be found in shops throughout the world.
- 14 A _____ of people said they would support the new proposals.
- 15 He was responsible for the special effects in a number of Hollywood _____ such as *Titanic* and *Jurassic Park*.